

EBM — Execution Boundary Module

Parent Standard: Harness Architecture Standard

Parent Architecture: **Execution Layer — Enforcement Standard**

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Execution Boundaries

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Compatibility: OOF® Methodology OS™ · **Harness Architecture Standard** ·

Execution Layer — Enforcement Standard · **RIS** · **INTEGROS®** · **OGL™** · **ART** · **OIB™**

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

Execution Boundary Module defines the structural conditions under which a system establishes, preserves, and enforces the boundary of its executable action environment.

A system satisfies EBM only if:

- the execution boundary is explicitly defined
- executable space is distinguishable from non-executable space
- action surfaces remain bounded under governed conditions
- boundary crossing is restricted, traceable, and non-silent
- execution does not proceed outside the defined containment environment

A system that cannot define where execution is allowed to occur does not satisfy EBM.

Module Function

EBM defines the primary containment boundary of execution.

It ensures that execution is not treated as a free operational field, but as an activity that must occur only inside a defined, governed, and limited environment.

The module applies wherever systems must distinguish between:

- what may be executed
- where it may be executed
- what remains outside valid execution scope
- when execution must stop at the boundary rather than continue across it

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

Step 1 — Define the Execution Environment

The organization must define the contained environment in which execution is permitted.

Minimum requirement:

- the execution environment is explicit
- permitted execution zones are distinguishable
- undefined execution areas are excluded from valid operation

Step 2 — Define Boundary Conditions

The system must define where the execution boundary begins and ends.

Minimum requirement:

- boundary conditions are explicit
- internal and external execution spaces are distinguishable
- silent boundary ambiguity is excluded from valid containment

Step 3 — Define Allowed Action Surface

The system must define what kinds of actions may occur within the boundary.

Minimum requirement:

- executable action types are explicit
- non-permitted action surfaces are identifiable
- execution does not expand beyond declared operational scope

Step 4 — Define Boundary Crossing Restrictions

The system must define how attempts to move beyond the valid execution boundary are restricted.

Minimum requirement:

- crossing restrictions are explicit
- out-of-bound execution is blocked, limited, or escalated
- silent execution spillover is excluded from valid operation

Step 5 — Preserve Boundary Traceability

The system must preserve visibility of boundary conditions and any attempt to approach or cross them.

Minimum requirement:

- boundary events are traceable
- later review can reconstruct where execution occurred relative to boundary
- containment does not depend on invisible assumptions

Step 6 — Restrict Invalid Execution

The system must not be treated as valid if execution occurs outside the defined containment boundary or if the boundary can be silently widened.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid boundary conditions are identifiable
- execution outside defined containment is blocked or invalidated
- permission alone does not override boundary containment

Use Case 1 — Tool-Using Agent Inside a Controlled Runtime

Scenario

An AI agent is authorized to act inside a contained runtime, but must not access external execution surfaces beyond its approved environment.

Application

EBM is used to ensure:

- the valid execution environment is clearly defined
- external execution surfaces remain outside boundary
- boundary crossing attempts are restricted
- execution remains traceable relative to containment limits

Result

The organization gains a stronger basis for preventing **authorized execution** from silently expanding into uncontrolled action space.

Use Case 2 — Enterprise Workflow with Restricted Operational Zone

Scenario

A system may process, transform, and prepare actions internally, but must not directly execute beyond a defined operational boundary without controlled transition.

Application

EBM is used to ensure:

- internal execution space is explicit
 - the outer operational boundary is governed
 - non-permitted execution zones are blocked
 - boundary crossing cannot occur silently through convenience or hidden path
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Result

The organization gains a structurally governed execution perimeter instead of relying on assumed separation between internal logic and external effect.

Canonical Closing Statement

If execution has no governed boundary, containment does not exist.

Related Documents

→ [Harness Architecture Standard](#)

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